

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | SIEM / XDR | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | Remote

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and experienced Senior Security Engineer with a strong focus on Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and detection engineering. I have over five years of hands-on experience in enterprise security operations, specialising in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR (including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender), and CrowdStrike Falcon. In my current senior role at the University of the Arts London, I design and implement detection-as-code using Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and lead threat hunting and incident response across an 8,000-user environment. I write PowerShell automation scripts to improve detection and response capabilities and have deep expertise in Microsoft Entra ID identity security. I am seeking a remote-first or hybrid permanent Security Engineer opportunity where I can drive detection engineering excellence and continue building high-impact SIEM and XDR capabilities at scale.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors, Log Analytics), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, KQL (Kusto Query Language), detection-as-code, MITRE ATT&CK aligned detection frameworks
- **XDR / Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **SOAR / Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps), SOAR automation workflows, PowerShell scripting, automated triage and enrichment
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AAD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Threat Hunting and Incident Response:** KQL-based proactive threat hunting, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK framework, digital forensics, root cause analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Cloud and Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure (Log Analytics workspace, Azure Monitor, Azure AD), cloud security posture management
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, web filtering, DLP controls
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Architect and engineer Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployments, including data connector configuration, log ingestion from Microsoft 365, Azure, CrowdStrike, and on-premise sources into the Log Analytics workspace.
- Design and implement detection-as-code: author and tune KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques across identity, endpoint, email, and cloud telemetry.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automating alert triage, threat enrichment, incident creation, and response actions including account lockdown and host isolation.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using KQL across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying low-and-slow attack patterns, lateral movement, and credential abuse.
- Manage Microsoft Defender XDR suite (MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender) across an 8,000-user estate, tuning policies, responding to incidents, and optimising detection fidelity.

- Engineer Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and identity protection rules, reducing identity-based attack surface and aligning to Zero Trust architecture.
- Lead incident response engagements using NIST 800-61 lifecycle: scoping, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review with MITRE ATT&CK mapping.
- Author PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations tasks including log collection, bulk remediation, and scheduled security reporting.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform: configure prevention and detection policies, investigate endpoint alerts, and perform deep-dive forensic investigations using Falcon Insight.
- Oversee vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, prioritising findings and tracking remediation to closure with asset and application owners.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Delivered day-to-day SIEM operations using Microsoft Sentinel, writing KQL queries for threat detection, investigation, and data analysis across Microsoft 365 and Azure workloads.
- Developed Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and alert tuning to reduce false positives and improve signal quality for the security operations function.
- Built SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate phishing triage, failed login investigation, and privilege escalation alerting workflows.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), responding to endpoint and identity alerts and performing threat hunting across the estate.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform including prevention policy management, alert investigation, and threat containment actions.
- Contributed to Microsoft Entra ID identity security, including Conditional Access policy authoring, MFA deployment, and SSO integration across enterprise applications.
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus; triaged findings by risk rating and co-ordinated remediation with infrastructure and application teams.
- Supported incident response activities following NIST 800-61, producing incident reports with MITRE ATT&CK technique mapping and post-incident lessons learnt.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security tooling and infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) fintech platform, implementing endpoint protection, identity controls, and log monitoring.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate repetitive IT and security operations tasks, improving operational efficiency.
- Configured identity and access management controls including MFA and SSO across cloud services, reducing unauthorised access risk.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 audit preparation and internal security reviews, supporting documentation and evidence collection processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection engineering framework at UAL, authoring 40+ KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, significantly reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-fidelity threats.
- Built an end-to-end SOAR automation workflow in Microsoft Sentinel that automated phishing alert triage, cutting analyst investigation time per incident by over 60%.
- Led threat hunting investigations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, identifying and remediating previously undetected lateral movement activity across the estate.
- Engineered Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA deployment across 8,000 users, achieving full identity protection coverage within a structured phased rollout.
- Delivered proactive vulnerability management using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io, identifying and remediating critical weaknesses before exploitation.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)